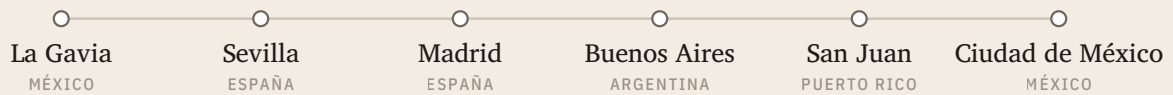


Destinos

The series, the textbook and the workbook, one episode at a time: what to learn, what to say, and what to check before you move on.



THESE NOTES BELONG TO

STARTED ON

How to use these notes

Each episode gets its own few pages: the story in easy Spanish, the words and verbs that matter, the grammar of the lesson, phrases you can use straight away, and a short test with the answers printed upside down. Nothing here is about later episodes, so you can read ahead of the video but never ahead of the story.

EL MÉTODO

Two sittings per episode

- | | | |
|---|-----------|--|
| 1 | DAY 1 | Before you watch. Read the episode's Antes de ver and the words in the textbook. Guess what will happen. |
| 2 | DAY 1 | Watch once. No pausing, no subtitles. Follow the story; half of the words is enough. |
| 3 | DAY 1 | From memory. Do the workbook's comprehension questions straight away, without rewatching. |
| 4 | DAY 1 | Watch again. This time pause. Copy five to ten sentences you could use yourself, then say each one out loud with the actor. |
| 5 | DAY 2 | Grammar. Read Gramática here and in the textbook, then find the same grammar in the episode. |
| 6 | DAY 2 | Workbook. Do the exercises with the book closed . Correct them with the key and redo every mistake the next day. |
| 7 | DAY 2 | Say it. Retell the episode out loud for a minute, record it, then write it down in Cuéntalo . |
| 8 | EVERY DAY | Flashcards. Your copied sentences go into Anki, Spanish on the front. Ten minutes a day keeps them. |

EL RITMO

How fast

Three or four episodes a week takes you through all fifty-two in about four months. Every fifth episode, rewatch an old one without subtitles: you will hear how much more you understand.

1

uno

La carta

The letter

WHERE LA GAVIA, MÉXICO



ANTES DE VER

Before you watch

- 1 The title is *La carta*. A letter arrives at a family's house. Who might send a letter that changes everything?
- 2 Old secrets: what kind of secret could a man keep for fifty years?
- 3 Listen for one word every time it comes back: **carta**. Count how many times you hear it.

LA HISTORIA

The story so far

Raquel Rodríguez es abogada. Vive y trabaja en Los Ángeles.

Raquel Rodríguez is a lawyer. She lives and works in Los Angeles.

Don Fernando Castillo es un señor muy viejo y está enfermo. Vive en La Gavia, una hacienda en México.

Don Fernando Castillo is a very old man and he is ill. He lives at La Gavia, an estate in Mexico.

Una señora de España, Teresa Suárez, le escribe una carta.

A woman from Spain, Teresa Suárez, writes him a letter.

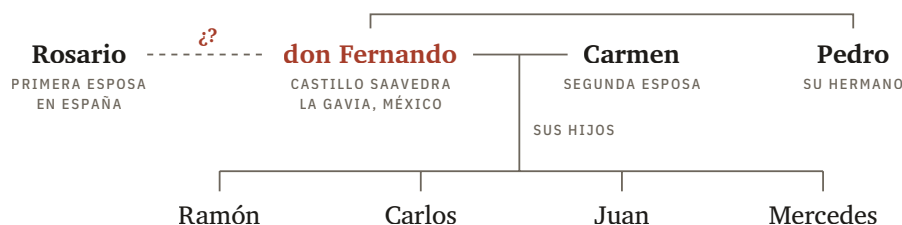
La carta habla de Rosario, la primera esposa de don Fernando. Él cree que Rosario murió en la Guerra Civil española.

The letter talks about Rosario, don Fernando's first wife. He believes Rosario died in the Spanish Civil War.

Don Fernando quiere saber la verdad. Raquel va a investigar el caso, y su viaje empieza en Sevilla.

Don Fernando wants to know the truth. Raquel is going to investigate the case, and her journey starts in Seville.

QUIÉN ES QUIÉN

Who's who**Raquel Rodríguez**

abogada, de Los Ángeles

*the lawyer who tells the story***Teresa Suárez**

una señora de Sevilla, España

writes the letter

VOCABULARIO

Words to keep

LA FAMILIA

el padre	father
la madre	mother
el hijo · la hija	son · daughter
los hijos	children (sons and daughters)
el hermano · la hermana	brother · sister
el nieto · la nieta	grandson · granddaughter
el esposo · la esposa	husband · wife
la familia	family

PERSONAS

el abogado · la abogada	lawyer
el señor · la señora	man · woman (polite)
don · doña	title of respect + first name

EL CASO

la carta	letter
el secreto	secret
la verdad	truth
la guerra	war
el caso	case
el viaje	journey; trip

DESCRIBIR

viejo · vieja	old
enfermo · enferma	ill; sick
primero · primera	first
muy	very
también	also; too

VERBOS

Verbs

ser IRREGULAR

to be (who or what someone is)

yo	soy
tú	eres
él · ella · usted	es
nosotros/as	somos
vosotros/as	sois
ellos · ellas · ustedes	son

ALSO IN THIS EPISODE

llamarse	me llamo · se llama	to be called
vivir	vive	to live
trabajar	trabaja	to work
escribir	escribe	to write
creer	cree	to believe
querer	quiere	to want; e becomes ie
saber	no sé · sabe	to know (a fact)
ir a + verb	va a investigar	is going to ...

GRAMÁTICA

Grammar

1.1 Ser: saying who someone is

Use **ser** to say who someone is, what they do and where they come from. Spanish usually drops the subject: *Soy Raquel* is more natural than *Yo soy Raquel*, because the ending already tells you who. Did you notice *está enfermo*? For how someone **is right now** (ill, tired, happy), Spanish switches to **estar**. That contrast comes back in later episodes.

Raquel es abogada.

Raquel is a lawyer.

Teresa Suárez es de España.

Teresa Suárez is from Spain.

Ramón y Carlos son hermanos.

Ramón and Carlos are brothers.

WATCH OUT No *un/una* before a job: **Raquel es abogada**, not ~~Raquel es una abogada~~. The article comes back only when you add an adjective: *Es una abogada muy buena*.

1.2 El or la: every noun has a gender

Learn every noun with its article. Most nouns in **-o** are masculine, most in **-a** are feminine, but the article is what you can trust: *el viaje*, *la verdad*. A masculine plural covers a mixed group, so *los hijos de don Fernando* includes his daughter Mercedes.

el hijo · los hijos

the son · the children

la carta · las cartas

the letter · the letters

el abogado · la abogada

the lawyer (man · woman)

WATCH OUT *Los padres* means **parents**, not only fathers. *Mis padres* = my mother and my father.

1.3 Asking: ¿Quién? ¿Dónde? ¿De dónde?

The narrator keeps asking you questions, and you can answer them out loud. Question words carry an accent, and a question opens with *¿*.

¿Quién es Rosario?

Who is Rosario?

¿Dónde vive don Fernando?

Where does don Fernando live?

¿De dónde es Teresa?

Where is Teresa from?

WATCH OUT No 's in Spanish. Possession goes with **de**: *la carta de Teresa*, *el hermano de don Fernando*.

FRASES ÚTILES

Say them out loud

Me llamo Raquel.

My name is Raquel.

¿Cómo se llama?

What is his / her / your name?

Es de Los Ángeles.

She's from Los Angeles.

Vive en México.

He lives in Mexico.

Es el hermano de don Fernando.

He is don Fernando's brother.

¿Quién es?

Who is it? / Who is he / she?

No sé.

I don't know.

Quiere saber la verdad.

He wants to know the truth.

PRONUNCIACIÓN

and culture

PRONUNCIACIÓN

R at the start of a word

An **r** at the start of a word is rolled, just like **rr**. Every name in this episode is practice: **Raquel**, **Rodríguez**, **Rosario**, and **guerra**. Between vowels a single **r** is one quick tap: *Teresa*, *primera*. Say *pero* (but) and *perro* (dog) until they sound different.

CULTURA

Don, doña, and two surnames

Don and *doña* go before a **first name** to show respect to an older person: *don Fernando*, never ~~*don*~~ *Castillo*. And Spanish speakers carry two surnames, father's first and mother's second: *Fernando Castillo Saavedra*. After the Civil War (1936–1939), Mexico took in thousands of refugees from Spain.

PONTE A PRUEBA

Test yourself

1 ¿Quién es Raquel Rodríguez?

2 ¿Dónde vive don Fernando?

3 ¿Quién escribe la carta? ¿De dónde es?

4 ¿Quién es Rosario?

5 Fill in: Raquel ___ abogada. Ramón y Carlos ___ hermanos.

6 Correct the mistake: *Raquel es una abogada*.7 *el* or *la*? ___ carta · ___ secreto · ___ verdad · ___ viaje8 Translate: *Pedro is don Fernando's brother*.

9 Write the question: ¿_____ es Teresa? — Es de España.

10 Does *los hijos de don Fernando* include Mercedes?

CUÉNTALO*Retell it in Spanish*

don Fernando · viejo y enfermo · La Gavia · una carta · Teresa
 Suárez · Rosario · la Guerra Civil · Raquel · investigar · Sevilla

HECHO*Done*

- | | | |
|--------------------------|--|------------|
| ☐ | Before you watch. Antes de ver, and the new words in the textbook | DATE _____ |
| ☐ | Watch once. No pausing, no subtitles | DATE _____ |
| ☐ | From memory. Workbook comprehension questions, without rewatching | DATE _____ |
| ☐ | Watch again. Pause, copy 5–10 sentences, say them with the actor | DATE _____ |
| ☐ | Grammar. Gramática here and in the textbook | DATE _____ |
| ☐ | Workbook. Exercises with the book closed, then the key | DATE _____ |
| ☐ | Say it. One minute out loud, recorded, then Cuéntalo | DATE _____ |
| ☐ | Flashcards. This episode's sentences are in Anki | DATE _____ |

ANSWERS 1 Es abogada. Vive en Los Angeles. 2 En La Gavia, una hacienda en México. 3 Teresa Suárez. Es de España. 4 La primera esposa de don Fernando. 5 es · son 6 Raquel es abogada. 7 la · el · la · el 8 Pedro es el hermano de don Fernando. 9 ¿De dónde es Teresa? 10 Yes. The masculine plural covers a mixed group.